

JONATHAN EVESO

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 10+ years as academic project manager at a Nigerian university; led research teams (2–20+) collaborating with ~10 researchers across Africa, Europe, and South America (institutions with 100–20,000+ employees).
- Secured €70K+ in competitive funding (DAAD, PTDF, PASET-RSIF doctoral scholarships, & TETFUND research grants); delivered 20 courses (3,500+ students, ~1,350 hours), 4 bachelor thesis supervisions, 8 publications, 5 conference presentations.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Science coordination, project management/administration, funding, knowledge transfer, research strategy. R/RStudio/Shiny, Git/GitHub, Asana/Notion, geospatial/big data analysis, reproducible workflows.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Max Planck Institute of Animal Behavior (MPI-AB)
PhD Researcher / Project lead

Radolfzell, Germany
Dec 2023 – Date

MPI-AB is an institute within the Max Planck Society (MPG), a global research network of 85 institutes, employing over 24,000 staff. The MPG is supported by more than €2 billion in annual public and competitive research funding.

- Leading a multi-year research project within the Animal–Environment Interactions Group, delivering 1 peer-reviewed publication, 3 thesis chapters, 2 conference talks, and 4 public/expert presentations.
- Coordinating 10+ international collaborators (Europe/South America/ Africa), managing timelines, data sharing, and cross-cultural communication (in-person and remote).
- Oversaw end-to-end for large(~10 TB) heterogeneous datasets; acquisition, cleaning, integration, quality control, and secure multi-platform storage.
- Applied advanced analytics (statistical modeling, geospatial analysis, machine learning workflows in R) to generate actionable insights from large, complex datasets.
- Communicated technical findings to diverse audiences, translating scientific outputs into accessible insights for stakeholders, policymakers, and the general public.

Federal University Gashua - FUGA (2015-2023)

Gashua, Nigeria

FUGA is a public university in Gashua, Yobe State, Nigeria with ~1,500 staff, ~7,000 students; academic staff ranked top 10 most-cited in Africa for Biological/Agricultural Sciences, Elsevier SciVal/SCOPUS 2025. Reason for leaving: moved to Germany as a PhD researcher on scholarship.

Lecturer 1**Oct 2019 – May 2023**

- Reported to the Head of Department, Forestry and Wildlife Management; Intermittently led the 27-member department in acting capacity (2018-2021, 4 years).
- Managed annual departmental budget of ~ ₦ 2 Million ensuring efficient allocation.
- Taught and graded 12 courses for 3,500+ students, delivered about 1,350 contact teaching hours, and supervised 2 undergraduate thesis
- Published 3 peer-reviewed journal papers, 2 conference presentations, 1 grant award, and supervised 2 undergraduate research projects to completion.

Lecturer II**Oct 2016 – Sept 2019**

- Coordinated departmental Nursery and wildlife domestication projects; examinations with Faculty Examination Officer that cut logistics lag 50% & boosted result computation 35%
- Advised and mentored student association thereby boosting peer/student-staff academic interactions by +25%
- Published 4 articles; 2 conference presentations; Taught and assessed 8 courses (3 academic sessions); supervised 2 undergraduate Research Projects to completion.

Assistant Lecturer**Sept 2015 – Sept 2016**

- Coordinated teams of staff and students 3 Field trips to Zoos, Game reserves and national park which improved student practical experience by 30-45%
- Published 1 journal article and presented at 1 conference.

Ogba Zoo and Nature Park**Benin City, Nigeria****Manager / Conservation Education Officer****June 2014 – May 2015**

Ogba Zoo and Nature Park is a state-owned, privately managed wildlife facility on ~750 hectares, 100 staff, 70K–120K visitors/year, ~₦100M/€110K revenue; Nigeria's top public-private zoo for 26+ years. Reason for leaving: Left for academia (Lecturer).

- Reported to the CEO/MD; led daily zoo operations; Managed all staff across 4 departments.
- Ensured the welfare of 100+ animals, protected the 750-ha grounds against encroachment.
- Facilitated 20+ academic research projects; Introduced enclosure enrichments that increased in visitor traffics by 10+ %
- Upgraded Zoo Museum with taxidermy specimens, boosting conservation education 35%.

EDUCATION

- University of Ibadan, Ibadan, Nigeria | Master of Wildlife Management 2016
- University of Benin, Benin City, Nigeria | B. Agric. (Hons)
Forestry and Wildlife (Second Class - Upper Division) 2012

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English | Professional proficiency | C1

German | In training | A2-B1